

INTERNATIONAL STUDENT ENROLLMENT & COMPLIANCE REPORT

SLU 0405 DVA TEAM 10

1. Diana Chepkemai
2. Gemnuel Losbanes
3. Halimat Ojomu
4. ian kidiga
5. Karen Shokunbi
6. Mr Ranveer
7. Sathiya Priya
8. Tehreem Yawer

Report Structure

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Dataset Overview & Data Preparation

Applicant, Connect, SEVIS datasets — structure, size, identifiers

02

Data Cleaning & Integration

Missing values, deduplication, standardisation, PostgreSQL setup

03

Eligibility Analysis

97.9% eligibility rate, source channel & intake breakdown

04

Enrollment Document Compliance (I-20)

34.7% completion rate, regional & intake disparities

05

Government Fee Payment (I-901)

45.5% payment rate, timing patterns, risk clusters

06

Key Findings & Compliance Risks

Pipeline funnel, notable disparities, action priorities

DATASET OVERVIEW

APPLICANT

6,894 rows

24 columns → 6 clean

Primary Key:
Reference_ID

Eligibility, deposit, I-20
status tracking

CONNECT

34,341 rows

8 columns → 6 clean

Primary Key:
Reference_ID

Enrollment workflow &
status mirroring

SEVIS

3,524 rows

126 columns → 111 clean

Primary Key: SEVIS_ID

Government compliance, I-
901 fee records

Key Integration Issue: Applicant & Connect share Reference_ID (6,875 unique across 34,341 rows , ~5× duplication) requiring deduplication before analysis. No direct join key confirmed between SEVIS and Applicant/Connect. FIN_ID was 98.2% missing.

PROBLEM STATEMENT AND OBJECTIVE

International student enrollment management involves multiple datasets, compliance requirements, and document verification processes that can be difficult to monitor efficiently. Institutions often face challenges with inconsistent records, delayed document completion, and limited visibility into eligibility and compliance performance across regions and intakes.

OBJECTIVE

To analyze and visualize international student eligibility and compliance data using interactive dashboards that support data-driven monitoring and decision-making.

DATA CLEANING AND INTEGRATION

Dataset	Raw Rows	Clean Rows	Columns Dropped	Cleaned Dataset Link	Key Actions
SEVIS	3,524	3524	15 (100% empty)	Dataset link	Dates → ISO 8601, uppercase standardisation, sentinel values resolved
Applicant	6894	6,893	13	Dataset link	Deduplication to first Reference_ID, status Title-cased, typo fixed
Connect	34,341	6,875	17	Dataset link	Deduplication, timestamps synced to Applicant, column name fixed

** SEVIS filtered to passport-present records (1,657 of 3,524 raw). The 1,867 remaining records lack passport data and are excluded from compliance analysis.*

POSTGRESQL 16 SCHEMA

Three tables loaded: sevis_records (SEVIS_ID PK), applicant_records (reference_id PK), connect_records (reference_id PK). Master compliance view (v_compliance_master) built using LEFT JOINS, 6,893 records, zero discrepancies across core KPIs validated against Looker Studio.

COMPLIANCE SCORECARD — AT A GLANCE

6,893

Total Applicants

across all academic intakes

97.9%

Eligibility Rate

6,748 eligible / 145 not

34.7%

I-20 Completion

2,389 issued · 4,486 pending

45.5%

I-901 Fee Payment

1,602 paid · 1,869 unpaid

21.9%

Deposit Paid

1,512 confirmed

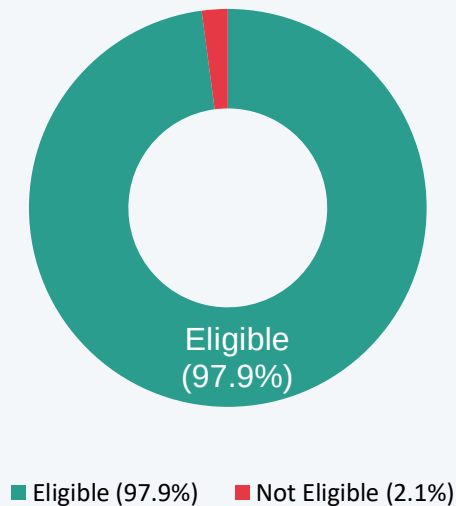
18.2%

Fully Ready

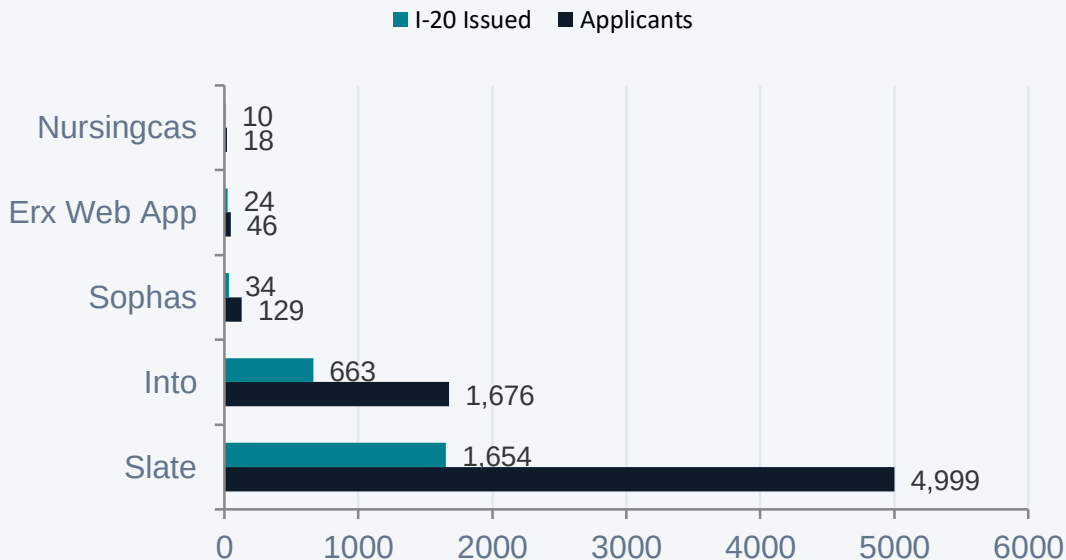
deposit + I-20 both confirmed

ELIGIBILITY ANALYSIS

Overall Eligibility

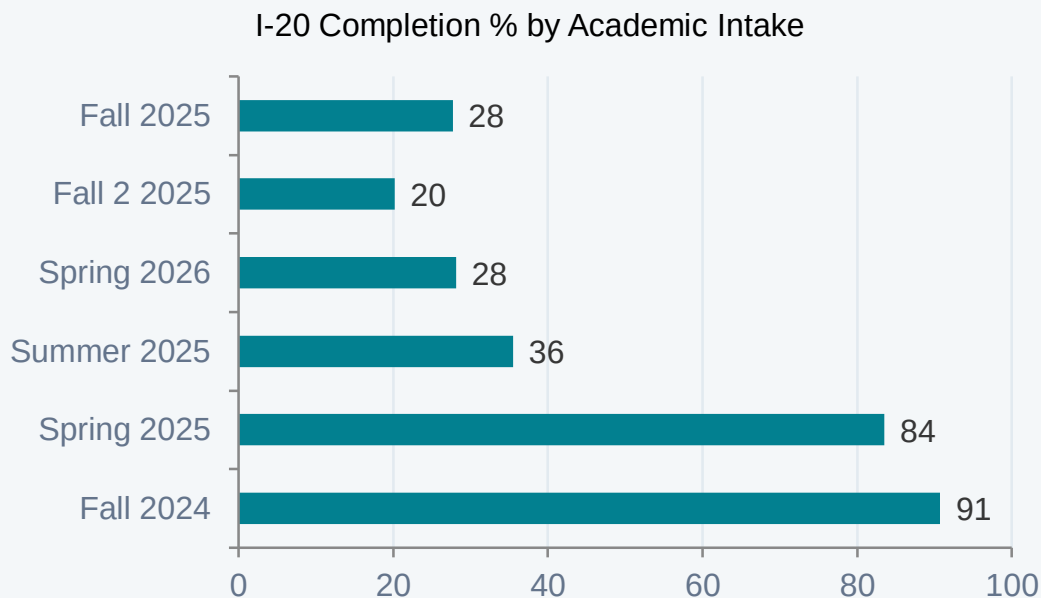


Applications & I-20 by Source



- 97.9% eligibility rate — admission decision processing is near-maximum efficiency
- Slate dominates: 72.5% of all applications but lower I-20 rate (33.1%) vs Into (39.6%)
- Only 145 students (2.1%) are ineligible — require immediate advisor review
- Fall 2025 largest intake (4,557); Fall 2024 (90.7% I-20) vs Fall 2025 (27.7%) — maturity effect

ENROLLMENT DOCUMENT COMPLIANCE (I-20)



2,389

I-20 Issued

4,486

I-20 Pending

65.3%

Pending Rate

90.7%

Fall 2024 Rate

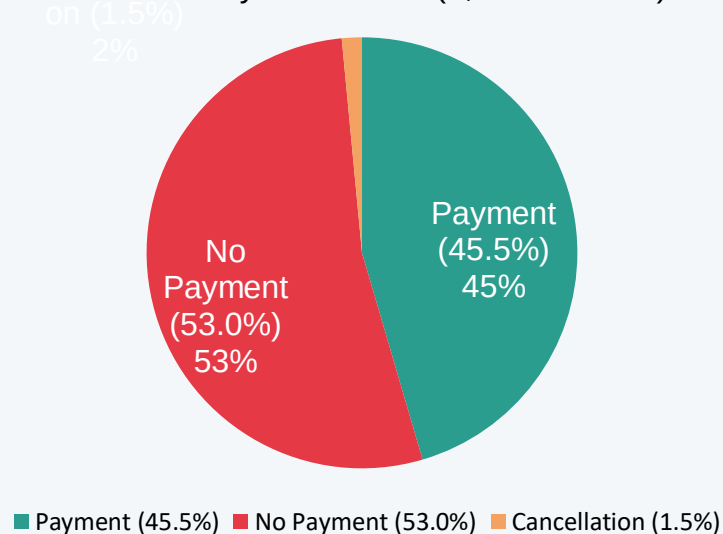
27.7%

Fall 2025 Rate

Critical: Fall 2025 has 4,557 students (66% of total) but only 27.7% I-20 completion. Processing capacity, not student eligibility, is the constraint. Nigeria (24.2%) and Ghana (24.8%) are the highest-volume underperformers requiring targeted advisor outreach.

GOVERNMENT FEE PAYMENT ANALYSIS (I-901)

I-901 Fee Payment Status (3,524 students)



Key Findings

- May 2025 = peak payment month (361 transactions)
- Nov 2024–Apr 2025: 50–150 payments/month only
- 53 cancellations (1.5%) need individual review
- 1,869 students (53%) have NO payment recorded
- Standard fee \$350, all 1,602 payments consistent
- Payment urgency drops sharply after peak month
- Students with deposit + I-20 but no I-901 cannot apply for F-1 visa

Highest Compliance Risk: 1,869 students (53%) have no I-901 payment on record, blocking visa issuance. With May 2025 peak now passed, a systematic outreach campaign segmented by intake, country, and agent channel is operationally urgent.

ENROLLMENT PIPELINE — STAGE DROP-OFF

Total Applicants — 6,893 (100%)

Deposit Confirmed -1,512 (21.9%)

I-20 Issued - 2,392 (34.7%)

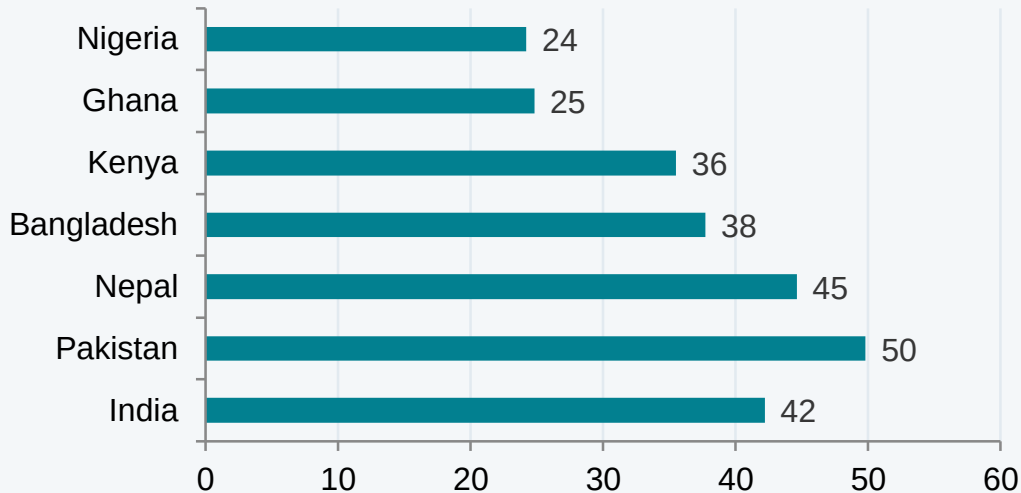
SEVIS Activated - 2,605 (37.8%)

Enrollment Ready - 1,241 (~18%)

Sharpest drop: Application → Deposit (-78.1%) | Deposit is the strongest predictor of downstream compliance progression | Only ~18% of all applicants are fully cleared

REGIONAL & CITIZENSHIP INSIGHTS

I-20 Completion Rate — Top Countries (%)



Region	Students	% of SEVIS
South Asia	650	39.2%
West Africa	620	37.4%
East Africa	166	10.0%
Southern Africa	105	6.3%
Other	50+35+25+6	~6%

South Asia + West Africa = 76.6% of SEVIS students

2,481

India - #1 country

78.98%

Via agent channel

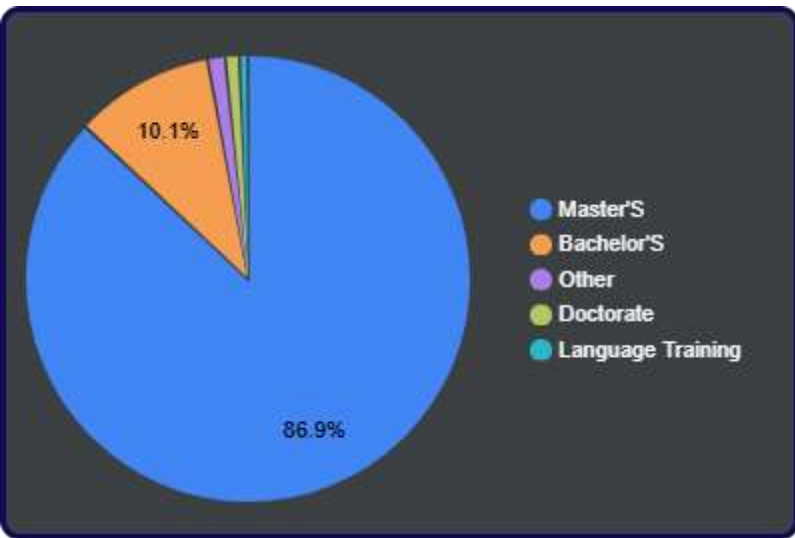
66%/34%

Male/Female split

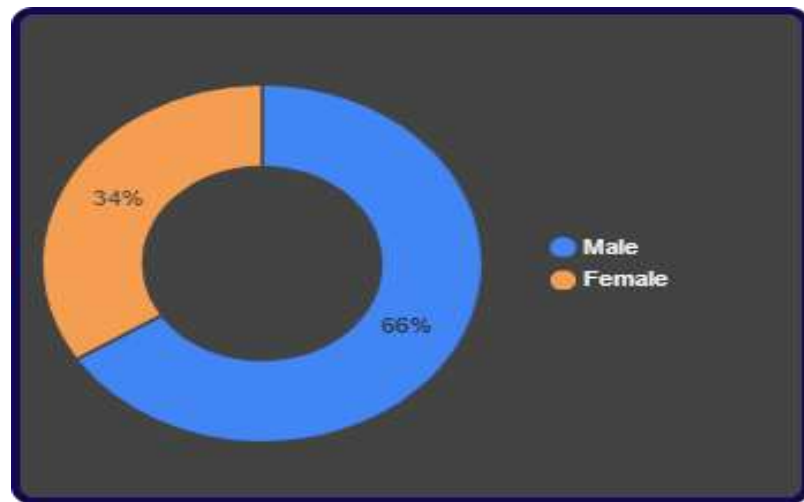
76.3%

Master's students

Student Demographics & Academic Profile

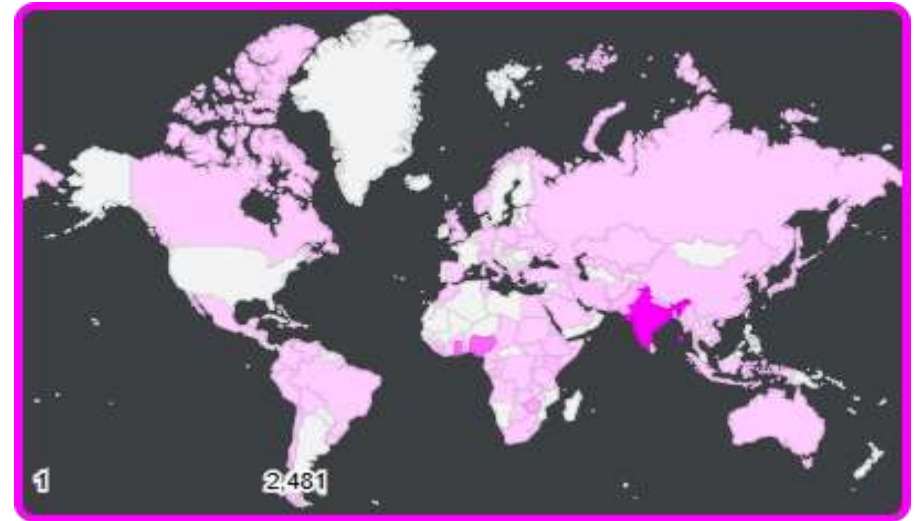
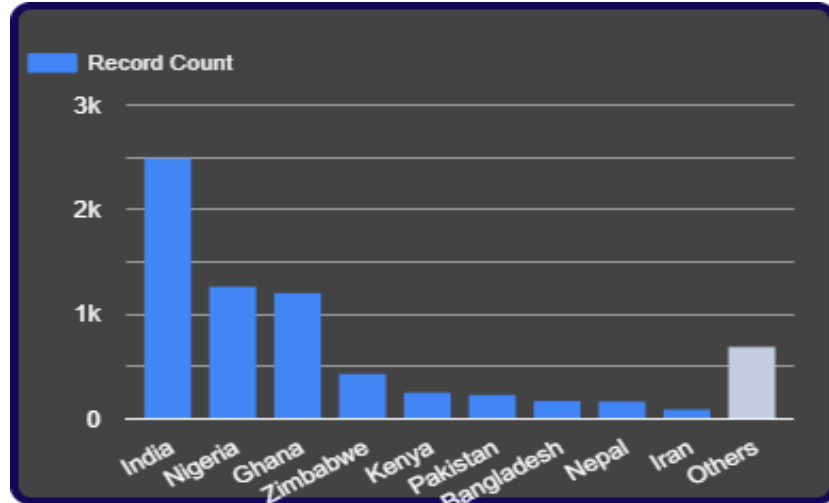


Master's programs account for the majority of applications, highlighting strong demand for graduate education and advanced academic programs.



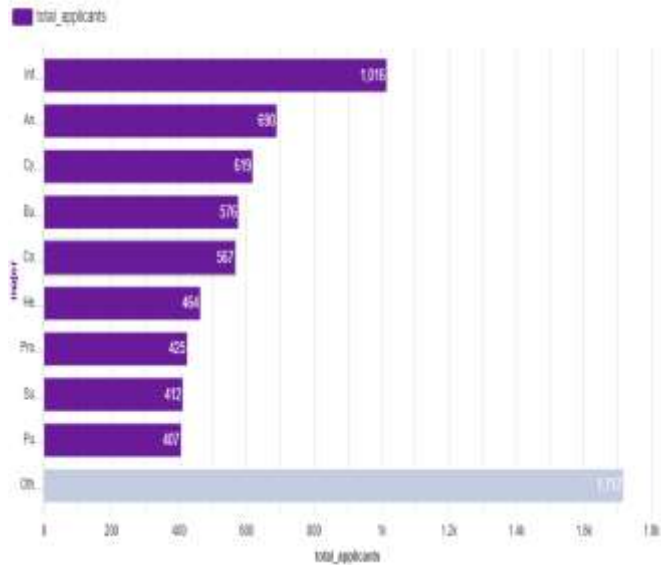
The applicant pool is predominantly male, indicating a gender imbalance across international applications while still maintaining meaningful female representation.

Top Countries by Application Volume

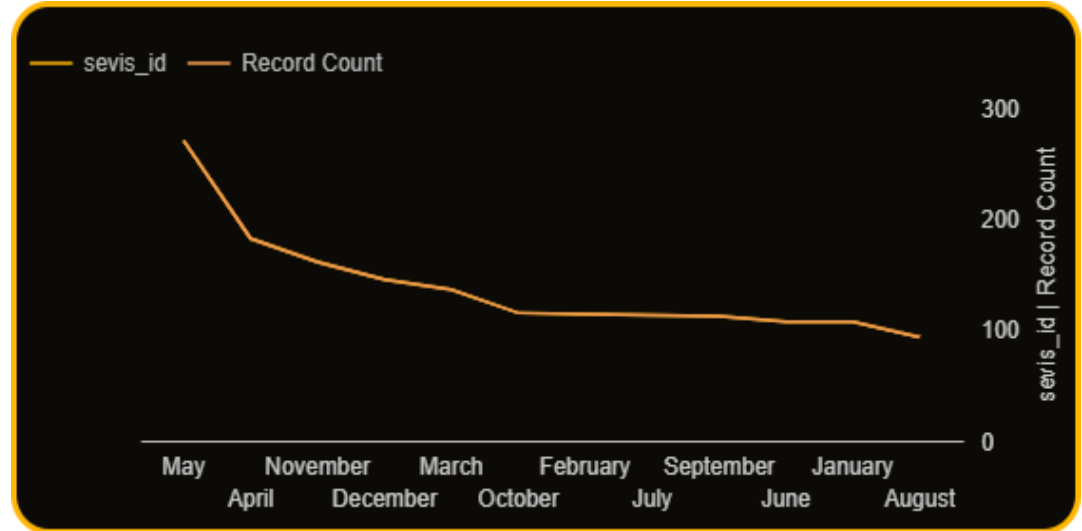


India remains the dominant source country, followed by key markets in Africa and South Asia. These regions should remain priorities for recruitment and compliance support.

Program Demand & Fee Payment Trends



Top programs (SEVIS):
Computer Science (200) ·
Medical Informatics (178) ·
CS General (152) · Cyber
Ops (117) · Informatics
(115)



Fee payments peaked in May 2025 before declining significantly, suggesting the need for continuous monitoring and targeted reminders throughout the enrollment cycle.

PIPELINE STAGE BREAKDOWN

Pipeline Stage	Deposit	I-20	Count	% of Total	Priority
Fully Ready	Yes	Yes	1,251	18.2%	✓ Compliant
Deposit only - I-20 pending	Yes	No	261	3.8%	High - visa blocked
I-20 only - deposit missing	No	Yes	1,139	16.6%	Follow-up needed
Early pipeline - neither	No	No	4,242	61.4%	Systematic engagement

ADVISOR ASSIGNMENT GAP

3,961 students (57.6%) have no advisor assigned, a structural capacity gap constraining individual compliance outreach.

- Deposit confirmed students are 5.7× more likely to complete SEVIS activation (68% vs 12%).
- Fall 2025 contains 4,557 students (66.1% of total) with only 27.7% I-20 completion, largest cohort, furthest behind.

DATA QUALITY AND KNOWN LIMITATIONS

- 1. No SEVIS↔Applicant Join Key** - FIN_ID was 98.2% missing; Non-Immigrant_ID ranges don't overlap Reference_IDs. Cross-system analysis is blocked until a bridge field is confirmed.
- 2. SEVIS Only INITIAL Status** - All 3,524 SEVIS records are INITIAL. No ACTIVE/TERMINATED students present. Dataset is a pre-enrollment point-in-time snapshot only.
- 3. I-901 Fee: 53% Unpaid** - 1,869 SEVIS students have no payment on record. Unclear if this is pre-payment timing or a data capture gap.
- 4. Applicant Financial Fields Empty** - All 16 financial/document columns (tuition, scholarships, ELC forms) are 100% null in the exported extract. Financial eligibility analysis not possible.
- 5. 57.6% Advisors Unassigned** - 3,961 of 6,875 students have NULL in the Assigned field. Whether blank = unassigned or a different state is unconfirmed.
- 6. Archival Data in SEVIS Fee Dates**- 25% of SEVIS records contain pre-2010 payment dates. Filter `i_901_transaction_date > 2023-01-01` for operational analysis.

SUMMARY OF KEY FINDINGS

- 97.9% eligibility rate: Admission decision quality is near-perfect; eligibility is NOT the compliance bottleneck.
- I-20 completion at 34.7% (4,486 pending) is the most operationally critical gap. Students cannot apply for F-1 visas without it.
- I-901 fee payment at 45.5% (1,869 unpaid) is the final barrier to visa eligibility for otherwise fully-ready students.
- Only 18.2% of all applicants (1,251) are Fully Ready, deposit confirmed AND I-20 issued.
- Fall 2025 (4,557 students, 66% of cohort) has only 27.7% I-20 completion. This is caused by processing capacity backlog, not student quality.
- Nigeria & Ghana: 2nd and 3rd largest source markets but I-20 rates of 24.2% and 24.8%. This requires targeted advisor outreach.
- 78.98% enrollment via agents enables structural dependency; agent performance by I-20/fee rate should be formally assessed.

RECOMMENDED ACTION PRIORITIES

1 RESOLVE I-20 PROCESSING BACKLOG

Focus on Fall 2025 (4,557 students, 27.7% rate). Review OIS staffing, automation, and SLA tracking. Escalate deposit-confirmed students with no I-20 after 30 days.

2 NIGERIA & GHANA ADVISOR COVERAGE

Despite being the 2nd and 3rd largest markets (2,432 combined), I-20 rates are 24.2% and 24.8%. Dedicated advisor support, documentation guidance, and agent performance reviews required.

3 SEVIS JOIN KEY RESOLUTION

Confirm with data team whether FIN_ID or an alternative field bridges SEVIS to Applicant/Connect. Full cross-system compliance analysis is blocked until this is resolved.

4 I-901 FEE PAYMENT CAMPAIGN

Target 1,869 unpaid students. Segment by intake, country, and agent. Automated reminders at deposit confirmation. Peak payment month (May) has passed, sustained campaign is needed.

5 ADVISOR ASSIGNMENT AUTOMATION

3,961 students (57.6%) are unassigned. Implement cohort-based or citizenship-based auto-assignment logic. 117 deposit-confirmed students have no advisor (highest attrition risk).

6 FULL DATA EXTRACT REQUEST

Request Applicant export with financial fields populated (tuition, scholarships, ELC forms). Request full SEVIS lifecycle export including ACTIVE/TERMINATED records.

DASHBOARD ACCESS

[Looker Studio Compliance Dashboard](#)

RECORDING LINK

<https://drive.google.com/file/d/1DSgIbR9MZBYJ7daMI1MzmkwMDSEgy2QU/view?usp=sharing>

THANK YOU